FIGHTERBASE

# Balanced

## Food list

Every allowed and avoided food, by type. A bit of everything, in sensible portions.



Prepared 10 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

> DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

# How to use this food list

This food list is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Balanced**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

## The colour key

| Green | Amber | Red | Blue |
|---|---|---|---|
| Allowed. Fits this style. | In moderation, small amounts or some versions. | Avoid. The reason is shown. | Check the label or how it is made. |
| **373** allowed | **132** in moderation | **0** avoid | **0** check label |

Brand products vary. This list is built from the FighterBase food catalogue of 505 common foods. If a food is not here, ask which group it belongs to and check the label.

AT A GLANCE

# Balanced on one page

No food groups cut out. Meals are built from protein, carbs, veg and some fat, with treats kept occasional. The style most sports nutrition guidance starts from.

### Mostly yes

- Beef steak (sirloin, rump, ribeye, fillet)
- Beef mince (5% to 20% fat)
- Salmon (fresh, farmed or wild)
- Trout
- Hen eggs (whole)
- Egg whites (carton)
- Spinach
- Kale
- Carrots
- Beetroot
- Strawberries
- Blueberries
- Almonds
- Walnuts
- Extra virgin olive oil
- Olive oil (light)

### Mostly no

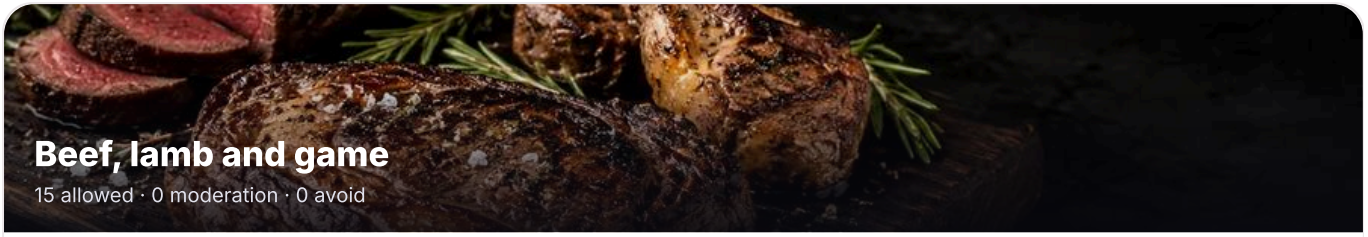
## The big ideas

1. Build most meals from four parts: a protein, a starchy carb, vegetables or fruit, and a little fat.
2. No food group is cut out and no food is banned.
3. Treats and takeaways are part of life, just not most of the week.
4. Drink mostly water, tea and coffee without sugar.
5. Eat regularly enough that you are not starving by evening.

**Talk to a professional first if:** You have a medical condition, allergy or intolerance that changes what you can eat; You are pregnant or breastfeeding; You are under 18 and training heavily (a coach or GP can point you to a sports dietitian).

THE FULL LIST

# Every food, by type



## Beef, lamb and game

15 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 15**

Beef steak (sirloin, rump, ribeye, fillet) · Beef mince (5% to 20% fat) · Beef joint (topside, brisket, silverside) · Beef short ribs and oxtail · Beef burgers (home-made, 100% beef) · Lamb chops, leg and shoulder · Lamb mince · Mutton · Goat · Venison · Rabbit · Wild boar · Bison and buffalo · Pheasant, partridge and grouse · Veal



## Pork and cured meats

5 allowed · 9 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 5**

Pork loin, chops and tenderloin · Pork belly and pork shoulder · Pork mince · Gammon and ham joint · Lard

**MODERATION 9**

Bacon (back and streaky) · processed · Sausages (pork) · processed · Sausages (beef or chicken, check the label) · processed · Ham slices (deli) · processed · Salami, chorizo and pepperoni · processed · Pork pies and scotch eggs · processed · Pate and liver sausage · processed · Black pudding · processed · Pulled pork (ready-made, sweetened sauce) · processed



## Poultry

8 allowed · 3 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 8**

Chicken breast · Chicken thighs and drumsticks (skin on or off) · Whole roast chicken · Chicken wings · Chicken mince · Turkey breast and turkey mince · Duck breast and duck leg · Goose

**MODERATION 3**

Chicken nuggets and breaded chicken · processed · Chicken sausages and deli chicken slices · processed · Rotisserie chicken (shop-bought, check seasoning) · processed



## Offal and bones

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 10**

Liver (beef, lamb, chicken) · Kidney · Heart · Tongue · Tripe · Bone marrow · Bone broth (home-made) · Beef dripping and tallow · Duck fat and goose fat · Gelatine and collagen powder



## Fish

26 allowed · 5 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 26**

Salmon (fresh, farmed or wild) · Trout · Mackerel · Sardines (fresh or tinned in oil or water) · Herring and kippers · Anchovies · Pilchards · Tuna (fresh steak) · Tuna (tinned) · Cod · Haddock · Pollock and coley · Plaice and sole · Sea bass and sea bream · Halibut and turbot · Hake · Whitebait · Skate · Monkfish · Swordfish · Catfish · Eel · Shark · Sturgeon and caviar · Fish roe (cod roe, salmon roe) · Cod liver oil

**MODERATION 5**

Smoked salmon · processed · Fish fingers and breaded fish · processed · Fish cakes · processed · Fish paste and pate · processed · Surimi and crab sticks · processed



## Shellfish and seafood

13 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 13**

Prawns and shrimp · King prawns and tiger prawns · Crab · Lobster · Langoustine and crayfish · Mussels · Oysters · Scallops · Clams and cockles · Whelks and winkles · Squid and calamari · Octopus · Cuttlefish



## Eggs

6 allowed · 2 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 6**

Hen eggs (whole) · Egg whites (carton) · Duck eggs · Quail eggs · Omelette and scrambled egg · Egg noodles

**MODERATION** 2

Mayonnaise · processed · Meringue · added sugar



## Milk and cream

10 allowed · 1 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED** 10

Whole milk · Semi-skimmed and skimmed milk · Lactose-free milk · Goat's milk and sheep's milk · Single, double and whipping cream · Soured cream and creme fraiche · Milk powder · Butter · Ghee (clarified butter) · Buttermilk

**MODERATION** 1

Condensed and evaporated milk · added sugar



## Yoghurt, kefir and soft cheeses

11 allowed · 1 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED** 11

Plain natural yoghurt · Greek yoghurt · Skyr · Kefir · Cottage cheese · Quark · Cream cheese · Ricotta · Mascarpone · Mozzarella · Paneer

**MODERATION** 1

Flavoured and fruit yoghurt · added sugar



## Hard and mature cheeses

9 allowed · 6 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED** 9

Cheddar · Parmesan and grana padano (animal rennet) · Edam and gouda · Emmental and gruyere · Brie and camembert · Blue cheese (stilton, gorgonzola) · Feta · Halloumi · Goat's cheese

**MODERATION** 6

Processed cheese slices and spreads · processed · Whey protein · processed · Casein protein · processed · Ice cream · added sugar · Custard and milk puddings · added sugar · Milkshakes · added sugar



## Plant proteins and soy

8 allowed · 4 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 8**

Tofu (firm, silken, smoked) · Tempeh · Edamame · Soya milk and soya yoghurt · Seitan (wheat protein) · Nutritional yeast · Miso · Natto

**MODERATION 4**

Soya mince and soya chunks · processed

Quorn and mycoprotein (many contain egg white) · processed

Plant-based burgers and sausages · processed

Pea protein and rice protein powder · processed



## Beans, lentils and pulses

20 allowed · 4 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 20**

Red lentils · Green and brown lentils · Puy lentils · Chickpeas · Black beans · Kidney beans · Cannellini and haricot beans · Butter beans · Pinto beans · Borlotti beans · Broad beans · Black-eyed peas · Split peas · Lupin beans · Hummus · Peanuts · Peanut butter · Green beans and runner beans · Garden peas and petits pois · Mangetout and sugar snap peas

**MODERATION 4**

Falafel · processed

Baked beans in tomato sauce · added sugar

Refried beans · processed

Bean and lentil pasta · processed



## Bread and bakery

14 allowed · 12 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 14**

Wholemeal and granary bread · Sourdough bread · Rye bread · Seeded bread · Pitta and flatbreads · Wraps and tortillas (wheat) · Corn tortillas · Naan and chapati · Bagels · Crumpets and muffins · Oatcakes · Almond-flour bread and wraps · Coconut-flour wraps · Cloud bread

**MODERATION 12**

White bread · processed

Gluten-free bread · processed

Croissants and pastries · added sugar

Pizza base · processed

Crackers and crispbreads · processed

Rice cakes · processed

Cakes and sponge · added sugar

Biscuits and cookies · added sugar

Doughnuts · added sugar

Pies and pasties · processed

Cereal bars and flapjacks · added sugar

Protein bars · added sugar

## Pasta, rice and grains

36 allowed · 5 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 36**

Wheat pasta (white or wholewheat) · Egg pasta and fresh pasta · Noodles (wheat) and ramen · Rice noodles · Glass noodles · Couscous · Bulgur wheat · Semolina · Freekeh, spelt, farro and kamut · Barley and pearl barley · White rice (basmati, jasmine, long-grain) · Brown rice · Wild rice · Risotto rice · Oats (rolled and porridge) · Oat bran · Shredded wheat and wheat biscuits · Quinoa · Buckwheat · Amaranth · Millet · Sorghum · Teff · Polenta and cornmeal · Sweetcorn and corn on the cob · Popcorn · Chia pudding · Cauliflower rice · Courgette noodles (courgetti) · Konjac (shirataki) noodles · Flours: wheat and plain · Flours: rice, cornflour and maize · Flours: almond · Flours: coconut · Flours: chickpea (gram) · Flours: tapioca and arrowroot

**MODERATION 5**

Gluten-free pasta (corn or rice) · processed · Sushi rice · added sugar · Muesli and granola · added sugar · Breakfast cereals (cornflakes, bran flakes) · added sugar · Tortilla chips · processed

## Leafy and salad vegetables

12 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 12**

Spinach · Kale · Cabbage (green, red, savoy) · Spring greens and collards · Lettuce and salad leaves · Rocket and watercress · Chard · Pak choi and bok choy · Cucumber · Celery · Radishes · Bean sprouts

## Cruciferous and stalk vegetables

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 10**

Broccoli · Cauliflower · Brussels sprouts · Asparagus · Fennel · Artichoke · Kohlrabi · Leeks · Courgette and marrow · Aubergine

## Onions, peppers and tomatoes

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 10**

Onions and shallots · Garlic · Spring onions and chives · Peppers (red, green, yellow) · Chillies · Tomatoes (fresh, tinned, passata) · Tomato puree · Mushrooms (all types) · Olives · Avocado



## Roots, squash and starchy vegetables

22 allowed · 2 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 22**

Carrots · Beetroot · Parsnips · Swede and turnip · Celeriac · Butternut squash and pumpkin · Sweet potato · White potatoes (boiled, baked, mashed) · Chips (home-made, oven) · Roast potatoes · Yam · Cassava (yuca) and tapioca · Plantain · Taro · Jerusalem artichoke · Seaweed and nori · Sauerkraut · Kimchi · Pickles and gherkins · Frozen vegetables (plain) · Tinned vegetables (no added sugar) · Vegetable juice

**MODERATION 2**

Chips and fries (takeaway or frozen) · processed

Parsnip and potato crisps (vegetable crisps) · processed



## Fruit

28 allowed · 8 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 28**

Strawberries · Blueberries · Raspberries · Blackberries · Cranberries and redcurrants · Lemons and limes · Apples · Pears · Oranges and satsumas · Grapefruit · Peaches and nectarines · Plums · Apricots · Cherries · Kiwi · Melon (cantaloupe, honeydew) · Watermelon · Pineapple · Mango · Papaya · Grapes · Bananas · Figs (fresh) · Pomegranate · Passion fruit · Coconut (fresh flesh) · Smoothies (home-made, whole fruit) · Coconut water

**MODERATION 8**

Dates · added sugar

Raisins, sultanas and currants · added sugar

Dried apricots, figs and prunes · added sugar

Other dried fruit and fruit leather · added sugar

Tinned fruit in juice · added sugar

Tinned fruit in syrup · added sugar

Fruit juice · added sugar

Smoothies (shop-bought) · added sugar



## Nuts and seeds

21 allowed · 3 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 21**

Almonds · Walnuts · Cashews · Pecans · Hazelnuts · Brazil nuts · Macadamias · Pistachios · Pine nuts · Chestnuts · Mixed nuts (plain) · Chia seeds · Flaxseed (linseed) · Hemp seeds · Pumpkin seeds · Sunflower seeds · Sesame seeds and tahini · Poppy seeds · Almond butter · Cashew butter · Coconut flakes and desiccated coconut

**MODERATION 3**

Salted and flavoured nuts · processed

Trail mix (with dried fruit and chocolate) · added sugar

Hazelnut chocolate spread · added sugar

## Oils, fats and spreads

13 allowed · 4 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 13**

Extra virgin olive oil · Olive oil (light) · Avocado oil · Coconut oil · MCT oil · Flaxseed oil · Walnut oil · Sesame oil · Rapeseed (canola) oil · Sunflower oil · Vegetable oil and corn oil · Soybean oil · Palm oil

**MODERATION 4**

Margarine and baking spreads · processed · Dairy-free spreads · processed · Cooking spray · processed · Salad dressings (bottled) · added sugar

## Sugars, sweeteners and sweet foods

6 allowed · 19 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 6**

Stevia · Monk fruit · Erythritol and xylitol · Aspartame, sucralose and saccharin · Dark chocolate 85% or higher · Cocoa powder (unsweetened)

**MODERATION 19**

White and brown sugar · added sugar · Honey · added sugar · Maple syrup · added sugar · Agave syrup · added sugar · Golden syrup, treacle and molasses · added sugar · Date syrup and date paste · added sugar · Coconut sugar · added sugar · Jam, marmalade and fruit spreads · added sugar · Milk chocolate · added sugar · Dark chocolate 70% or higher · added sugar · White chocolate · added sugar · Sweets, gummies and jelly · added sugar · Marshmallows · added sugar · Fizzy and boiled sweets · added sugar · Energy gels and chews · added sugar · Sherbet and candyfloss · added sugar · Fruit pastilles and wine gums · added sugar · Protein ice cream and low-sugar desserts · processed · Vegan chocolate · added sugar

## Herbs, spices and flavourings

16 allowed · 3 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 16**

Salt (sea, table, rock) · Black pepper · Basil, oregano, thyme and rosemary · Parsley, coriander, mint and dill · Sage, bay and tarragon · Cumin, coriander seed and fennel seed · Turmeric · Paprika and smoked paprika · Chilli flakes and cayenne · Cinnamon, nutmeg and cloves · Ginger (fresh and ground) · Garlic powder and onion powder · Mustard seeds · Vanilla (pods) · Curry powder and garam masala (check blends) · Mixed herbs and Italian seasoning

**MODERATION 3**

Vanilla extract (alcohol-based) · alcohol · Seasoning mixes and rubs (check label) · processed · Stock cubes and gravy granules · processed

## Sauces and condiments

15 allowed · 13 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 15**

Mustard (English, Dijon, wholegrain) · Soy sauce · Tamari (wheat-free soy sauce) · Coconut aminos · Fish sauce · Worcestershire sauce · Hot sauce (chilli) · Apple cider vinegar · White wine, red wine and rice vinegar · Malt vinegar · Pesto (basil and pine nut) · Dairy-free pesto · Salsa · Guacamole · Gravy (home-made, no flour)

**MODERATION 13**

Tomato ketchup · added sugar · Brown sauce · added sugar · BBQ sauce · added sugar · Mayonnaise (light) · processed · Oyster sauce · added sugar · Sriracha · added sugar · Balsamic vinegar · added sugar · Curry sauce (jar) · added sugar · Pasta sauce (jar) · added sugar · Sweet chilli sauce · added sugar · Teriyaki sauce · added sugar · Hoisin sauce · added sugar · Coleslaw (shop-bought) · added sugar

## Drinks

14 allowed · 13 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 14**

Water (still and sparkling) · Tea (black, green, white) · Herbal and fruit teas · Coffee (black) · Coffee with milk or cream · Decaffeinated coffee and tea · Electrolyte tablets and powders (sugar-free) · Oat milk · Almond, cashew and hazelnut milk · Coconut milk drink · Rice milk · Pea milk · Alcohol-free beer · Bone broth drink

**MODERATION 13**

Hot chocolate · added sugar · Squash and cordial · added sugar · Fizzy drinks (cola, lemonade) · added sugar · Diet and zero-sugar fizzy drinks · processed · Energy drinks · added sugar · Sports drinks · added sugar · Kombucha · added sugar · Beer and lager · alcohol · Cider · alcohol · Wine (red, white, rose) · alcohol · Spirits (whisky, gin, vodka, rum) · alcohol · Liqueurs and alcopops · alcohol · Gluten-free beer · alcohol

## Ready meals and takeaway

5 allowed · 13 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 5**

Sushi · Home-made vegetable soup · Jacket potato with filling · Salad with grilled chicken · Stir-fry (home-made)

**MODERATION 13**

Pizza · processed · Burgers in buns · processed · Kebabs · processed · Fish and chips · processed · Takeaway curry with rice · processed · Chinese takeaway · added sugar · Sandwiches and subs · processed · Crisps · processed · Pot noodles and instant noodles · processed · Ready meals · processed · Tinned soup (check label) · processed · Sausage rolls · processed · Burrito and fajitas · processed

## Supplements

10 allowed · 2 moderation · 0 avoid

**ALLOWED 10**

Creatine monohydrate · Fish oil (omega-3) · Algae omega-3 · Vitamin D3 (from lanolin) · Vitamin D (from lichen) · Multivitamin and mineral tablet · Magnesium · Caffeine tablets · BCAAs and EAAs · Collagen peptides

**MODERATION 2**

Pea or rice protein · processed · Soy protein · processed

READ THE LABEL

# Hidden ingredients

Ingredients can hide in the small print. Look for these on packaging, menus and supplements.

- Added sugar: sucrose, glucose syrup, fructose, honey, dextrose
- High salt: more than 1.5 g salt per 100 g is high
- Saturated fat: more than 5 g per 100 g is high (UK traffic-light labels)

## For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

# Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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